

id presents Remote Work Best Practices at Mesosphere

- Remote Without Warning Webinar: How to adapt and thrive as a suddenly-remote company
- Preparing Your Team for Remote Work Webinar
- The End of the Office and Scaling Remote Teams with Savannah Peterson & GitLab Sid Sijbrandij
- Top tips for employees and companies forced into work from home and remote work
- theCUBE: How GitLab has scaled as an all-remote company with Sid Sijbrandij
- Modern Work: Finding Structure in an Officeless World

Podcasts

- A Whole New Level · Building & Scaling Remote Teams with Sam Corcos and Darren Murph
- The Future of Work Project · Darren Murph // Unlocking the Super Powers of Remote, and its Positive Effects on Families
- Workology - Building the Future of Work Remotely With Darren Murph
- HR Leaders Podcast · How GitLab Creates and Sustains Scalable Remote Practices
- Grafana Labs - Remote work done right: How remote-first companies put people first
- Collaboration Superpowers - Live The Remote Dream
- The Modern People Leader - How culture is built outside of company walls
- The Dan Smolen Experience · Unleash the Remote Workforce
- How I Work Podcast · GitLab's Head of Remote, Darren Murph, on how to create corporate culture when no one works from the office
- SafetyWing Podcast · How to transition to remote
- Changelog Podcast · Creating GitLab's remote playbook
- The Recruitment Network Podcast · The Future of Remote Working with Darren Murph
- Wise Up with Cristina Podcast - Darren Murph, Remote Rebel, on Opportunities Beyond Work
- Yac Podcast: The Man, The Myth, The Head of Remote Legend
- Working Without Borders: Darren Murph on leading a remote culture at GitLab
- Customer Centric Podcast · Darren Murph: home is where the office is
- OpenFin MVP Podcast · All-remote before it was mandatory with GitLab's Brendan O'Leary
- Bright & Early Podcast · Darren Murph: Remote Work at GitLab
- Outside The Valley · Darren Murph of GitLab: Why Companies Should Go All-Remote
- Accelerating Support Podcast: Darren Murph, Head of Remote at GitLab
- The Changelog: GitLab's Master Plan
- The Twenty Minute VC: A podcast interview with GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij
- Coder Radio interview with Sid on 100% remote work and the GitLab model

Articles

- Lessons learned from GitLab about remote work - Team Topologies interview with Darren Murph
- LinkedIn Talent on Tap: Tips for a productive all-remote workforce
- GitLab's secret to managing 160 employees in 160 locations - Interview by Y Combinator
- GitLab's remote-only presentation, 2017
- Software Engineering Daily: GitLab with Sid Sijbrandij
- Outklip Blog: Using Video for Remote Work: Q&A with GitLab CEO
- Arc Blog: Work Like Automattic, Buffer & GitLab - Remote Operations at Top Distributed Companies

Threads and conversations

- HackerNews thread about all-remote page

- HackerNews thread about why more companies aren't remote

Resources on remote work

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Articles

- Amplify Accelerator Open Source Learning Lab
- Why remote work leads to a stronger company culture
- How companies benefit when employees work remotely
- Why working from home is a "future-looking technology"
- Why does writing matter in remote work?
- Krisp · Working From Home: A Beginner's Guide
- Slack Blog · How Toptal and GitLab build community and work-life balance in Slack
- The firm with 900 staff and no office
- The distributed workplace
- Why office hours are obsolete
- It's time to factor remote work into our urban planning
- 23 key remote work and telecommuting statistics for 2019
- How remote work can reduce stress and revitalize your mindset
- The 1 trait all remote workers need -- here is how to cultivate it
- The Financial Benefits of Working Remotely (for Companies and Employees)
- 6 ways in which offering flexible working makes you a great employer
- 5 reasons remote teams are more engaged than office workers
- Remote work becoming "new normal"
- Here's why remote workers are more productive than in-house teams
- The benefits of and questions facing remote and distributed startups
- The end of an era for easyDNS
- Engagement around the world, chartered - HBR
- Helping Creativity Happen from a Distance
- How to build a remote team
- Remote work doesn't scale... or does it?
- Case Closed: Work-From-Home is the World's Smartest Management Strategy
- A Long Commute Could Be the Last Thing Your Marriage Needs
- 6 People Who Prove You Don't Have to Sacrifice Your Career to Work Remotely
- After Growing to 50 People, We're Ditching the Office Completely
- On-Premise Tribes in Shiny Caves
- The benefits - and pitfalls - of working in isolation
- It's not just the isolation. Working from home has surprising downsides
- The Day They Invented Offices
- That remote work think piece has some glaring omissions (a rant)
- Tweets about the impact by Amir Salihendic
- Martin Fowler on remote vs. co-located
- Top 5 Reasons Why Companies Adopt Remote Work
- Remote Work 1-2-3: First Three Steps to Going Remote
- Work is Work: In which returns diminish

Best practices

- Communication Debt - How and Why to Keep Your Team Out of It
- Hiring top talent from generation Z: 14 essential recruitment tips
- Remote Ideation: Synchronous vs. Asynchronous
- How to create genuine camaraderie among remote workers
- How remote businesses can attract high-quality job candidates
- Six lessons we learned while scaling a distributed startup
- How to inspire and motivate your team that works from home
- How to separate home-life from working-from-home life
- How these 5 secrets help remote workers thrive
- 5 ways to cultivate a healthy mindset in a remote team
- Remote work is here to stay: Here's how to avoid three common compliance issues
- How to lead those working remotely
- How to build a successful remote business
- How to stay productive when you're working remotely
- 10 tips for improving your remote conversations
- 450 remote workers reveal how to boost productivity when working from home
- Managing Remote Employees: Best Practices from Doist's Head of Marketing
- The future of work is distributed. Here's how your company can strategize.
- Leading remotely - What every manager should know
- Why engaging remote workers is good people business and how to do it
- How to Pitch Your Boss on a Remote Working Arrangement
- 4 golden rules for living the laptop lifestyle
- 5 ways to make your remote team more effective
- How to make remote work, work
- 5 ways to stay motivated when you work remote
- Five mistakes that destroy the efficiency of your remote workers
- These Are the 8 Best macOS Apps for Working Remotely
- Remote working tips by Groove
- Guidelines for Effective Collaboration
- The Ultimate Guide to Remote Standups
- How Do You Manage Global Virtual Teams?
- Guide to leading and managing distributed teams
- Getting Virtual Teams Right
- Introverts at Work: Designing Spaces for People Who Hate Open-Plan Offices
- How to get the most out of employees who work from home
- How to manage employees who work from home
- How to manage a distributed development team
- Managing Remote Developer Teams: How Buffer Set the Gold Standard - Interview with Katie Womersley
- What Is the Best Compensation Model?

Surveys and data

- The Remote Work Report by GitLab: The Future of Work is Remote
- Sike Insights · EQ & Remote Managers Report
- Slack · A new guide for adapting to a radically different workplace
- Gartner CFO Survey Reveals 74% Intend to Shift Some Employees to Remote Work Permanently
- Headlamp · The Manager's Guide to Engaging Remote Workers
- IBM Study: COVID-19 Is Significantly Altering U.S. Consumer Behavior and Plans Post-Crisis
- Why remote work has grown by 159% since 2005

- Greenhouse: Distributed hiring and remote working · The essential guide
- Google spent 2 years researching what makes a great remote team
- State of Remote Work 2021 by Buffer
- The IWG Global Workspace Survey - Welcome to Generation Flex
- 5 Important Takeaways From Google's Two-Year Study Of Remote Work
- Study: Adding 20 Minutes to Your Commute Makes You as Miserable as Getting a 19 Percent Pay Cut
- Remote Work 2020 Survey by Remote.Tools
- Is Working Remotely Effective? Gallup Research Says Yes

Videos, interviews, presentations

- LinkedIn's 2019 Global Talent Trends report
- Things I Wish I Knew Before Going Remote by Marla Brizel Zeschin
- Bond Internet Trends 2019: Remote work = creating internet-enabled work opportunities + efficiencies
- Work Remotely: Thrive in a Job From Home
- TechSAV's Brown Bag Series: Working & Managing Remote

Threads and conversations

- We Work Remotely Slack community
- remotechat - remote-focused Twitter chat every Wednesday
- Tweet thread about downsides of remote work
- HackerNews thread about remote work literature

Tools that enable remote teams

Here's a list of the tools we use internally at GitLab, with details on how we use them.

Elaine Z., investor at SignalFire, compiled an excellent summary of tools for remote teams to consider. Others are shared below.

Communication

- Slack - chat
- Zoom - video calls
- Google Workspace
- Yac - asynchronous voice collaboration for remote team
- 8x8 - unified communications (video, VoIP, etc.)

Design and collaboration

- MURAL - visual design collaboration
- Figma - design collaboration
- CoScreen - remote screen sharing

Empathy, culture, and team-building

- Sike Insights Kona - team personality, mood, and morale insights

Management

- GitLab Issues
- GitLab Pages
- Qatalog - work hub syncing multiple tools and services
- Range - team collaboration and management
- There - quick time zone reference for your global team
- Buildstack - an operating system and unified inbox for teams

Meetings

- Remeet
- Friday

Events, meetups, gatherings

- Hopin - all-in-one live online events platform
- Remo - virtual workspace tool

Co-working, communal workspaces, and third spaces

Remote work enables individuals and teams to create and contribute in places other than a home or conventional office. Many are familiar with WeWork and Regus, where a desk or office is available to rent. Post-COVID, leaders are recognizing the need to support the third space - a workplace that isn't one's home, and isn't an office.

Some organizations (like GitLab) provide stipends or reimbursement as a matter of inclusivity and productivity. Not every home is amenable to remote work, and not everyone is comfortable working in a traditional office. These communal workspaces provide the energy and camaraderie of working in-person as a group, with the flexibility of being near one's home (and in turn, avoiding a commute).

- Codi (residential coworking spaces in neighborhoods that matter to you)
- Switchyards (neighborhood work clubs)

Organizations for traveling remote work

- Remote Year
- Wifi Tribe
- Hacker Paradise
- Co-work Paradise
- Project Getaway
- B-Digital Nomad

Guides for remote work

- The Holloway Guide to Remote Work
- Google's Distributed Work Playbook
- The Art of Working Remotely
- Twist's Remote Work Guides

- Remote Habits
- 35 of the best Slack communities for remote workers
- Toggl's Guide to Working With Clients You've Never Met Face-to-Face

Contribute to this page

At GitLab, we recognize that the whole idea of all-remote organizations is still quite new, and can only be successful with active participation from the whole community. Here's how you can participate:

- Propose or suggest any change to this site by creating a merge request.
- Create an issue if you have any questions or if you see an inconsistency.
- Help spread the word about all-remote organizations by sharing it on social media.

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SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/scaling.md

On this page, we're detailing how scaling an organization works better with all-remote.

Does all-remote work at scale?

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Given the relative newness of all-remote, many people immediately wonder if a 100% remote company works well at scale. This is largely due to their unfamiliarity with the concept, and it overlooks a different question - does colocation work well at scale?

Many individuals have experienced success when working short-term with a small group of people who are not in the same place at the same time. This could be a group project in school, arranging a trip for friends or family, or planning a wedding.

There are fewer examples of large remote teams working successfully, though that is changing due to a variety of factors (e.g. advancements in internet infrastructure, rising costs of living in major metropolitan areas, etc.).

GitLab believes that all-remote is the future of work, and that it not only works well at scale, but works better at scale than antiquated colocated models.

In this GitLab Unfiltered video, GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij chats with Prof. Raj Choudhury of Harvard Business School on the topic of remote work.

In response to a question on whether or not all-remote is infinitely scalable, or whether there is an inflection point beyond a certain organization size, Sijbrandij offers the following.

- > It scales better than the other model. It's not that we [as an all-remote company] have to defend against the question of 'Does this scale?'
- >
- > A team in one room works really well. A team on one floor probably works OK. A team on multiple floors, you start having some problems. A team across multiple offices, it gets even harder. A team in multiple cities, it gets even harder. A team on multiple continents, that gets super hard. That model breaks down.
- >
- > There's very little benefit to colocation if you're such a big company. While the benefits of remote · writing down your processes, stimulating cross-company informal communication · those get much more pronounced at scale.
- >
- > It's not just that [all-remote] scales. It scales way better. - GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij

Colocation challenges at scale

include

What is often lost in pondering the feasibility of all-remote at scale is the inherent difficulty of creating efficiency across colocated companies with multiple offices.

Time zones

For a multinational corporation with even two offices, those two offices are remote to each other. While time zones are the bane of our existence at GitLab, they're no less thorny, for example, to an organization with one office in Singapore and another in Dallas.

Reducing headaches related to collaboration across time zones is not a problem which is unique or exclusive to remote. Because all-remote forces a company to lean heavily on documentation of culture and process from the start, a fully remote organization can adapt to the addition of new team members in new time zones with greater poise.

Too, colocated corporations which do not default to asynchronous communication in one office will likely struggle to operate in this manner when collaborating with colleagues in a difference office.

Real estate costs

As colocated companies scale in size, their spend related to real estate will swell. This not only encompasses office space, but related activities such as security, cleaning, remodeling, etc.

Conversely, the relative savings from a dearth of real estate grows larger as an all-remote team scales.

Moving or changing offices

As a colocated team grows in size, it may become necessary to move or change offices. This not

only requires a great deal of attention from a planning and execution standpoint, but it's costly in other areas. Moving creates disruption, which negatively impacts efficiency. Too, it can have a very real impact on employees who base their living arrangements on the proximity to work.

There's also the risk of a city becoming unaffordable or unattractive for talent, forcing a move to a new region altogether.

With an all-remote workforce, these risks are fully mitigated.

Second-class satellite offices

In any colocated enterprise where there is at least two physical offices, it becomes difficult to treat them as equals. While labeling offices as headquarters may indicate importance, employees and investors will likely look to the physical location of the executive team to make a determination on which has higher importance.

This creates unnecessary friction within the organization, particularly impacting those who do not work at the de facto HQ.

All-remote benefits at scale

With no company offices to maintain, all-remote organizations are able to recognize outsized agility and efficiency at scale.

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In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij discusses all-remote scalability (amongst other topics) with researchers from INSEAD.

> The more widespread an organization is, the less it benefits from being colocated. An all-remote organization will have to adopt the processes you'd use to control an organization at scale.

>

> Writing things down, recording things, and working asynchronously · we have to master those things early, so they become more prevalent in the organization. Hence, they are easier to scale.

>

> For example, we have the best onboarding process of any company in the world. It's not perfect · I can see lots of room for improvement · but no other company has 250+ tasks you need to complete when onboarding.

>

> That's more useful at scale. We just hired 600 people in 2019, and they were all able to benefit from that. · GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij

Team growth

A rapidly growing firm is able to grow even more quickly as an all-remote team, as leadership can focus solely on attracting the right talent and onboarding them appropriately. There are no meetings to plan for office expansion, no requests for families to relocate, and no budget

allocations devoted to real estate.

Hiring

By opening one's hiring pipeline to the world, you're able to capture a more diverse array of applicants. You're also able to recruit individuals who may otherwise opt out of the workforce completely, such as stay-at-home parents, caregivers, and military spouses.

By paying local rates, an all-remote company can save money on hiring costs overall and hire more people. By removing the "Are you willing to relocate?" question from the interview process, hiring teams are able to focus on what actually matters: aptitude, drive, passion, empathy, and one's ability to add value to the company.

Reduced ambiguity

All-remote teams need to be diligent about documenting culture and process from inception. This allows everyone, regardless of location or time zone, to have access to critical information without the burden of tapping someone on their shoulder and inquiring.

At scale, this has a pronounced impact on an organization's ability to reduce confusion and ambiguity. As a team grows, there are ever more people able to contribute, which allows documentation to work even better.

Conversely, small colocated teams are apt to eschew documentation with the assumption that they'll remain in close enough proximity to always share information face-to-face. This becomes increasingly problematic as the company scales, and increasingly difficult to remedy.

Knowledge dissemination

As any team scales, greater depths of organizational knowledge are acquired. Each additional hire brings in added expertise and experience. In a colocated setting, this influx of knowledge takes place, but it is unequally disseminated. Those physically close to the next new person are most likely to reap the benefits, while those in a different office · or even a different floor · will be disadvantaged in gleaning the same insights.

In an all-remote setting, everyone is equidistant in practical terms. When your "office" is a Slack room, there is less friction in reaching out to a new employee to seek advice. This has a profound impact at scale, and contributes to a more transparent work climate.

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Contribute your lessons

GitLab believes that all-remote is the future of work, and remote companies have a shared responsibility to show the way for other organizations who are embracing it. If you or your company has an experience that would benefit the greater world, consider creating a merge request and adding a contribution to this page.

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All-remote companies such as GitLab thrive through documentation. Crucially, this requires every team member to be equally invested in perpetuating documentation, creating a virtuous cycle of self-searching, self-service, and self-learning.

Assume your question is already answered

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It's not what you know. It's knowing where to look. This is true at GitLab and other organizations that are intentional about documenting processes, and it is entirely counter to how typical work environments are structured.

From the very first day at GitLab, it is imperative that new team members operate with the assumption that their questions are already answered. This is a profound process shift that may feel unnatural and inefficient.

For many · particularly team members joining from a colocated environment · this requires a retraining of sorts. You must force yourself to not default to tapping on the virtual shoulder of someone as soon as an inquiry comes to mind. Rather, team members should redirect that effort to searching.

- GitLab has assembled a guide to searching the website like a pro · an essential tool for those who are establishing this habit.
- The above pairs well with GitLab's guide to starting a remote job.

Self-service and self-learning in onboarding

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GitLab's onboarding process is highly unique. Each new hire is assigned an onboarding issue with dozens upon dozens of tasks, broken down into small, digestible chunks. While the issue guides new hires to complete certain tasks on certain days, being a manager of one · an operating principle of Efficiency · applies from the very beginning.

There is a stark lack of hand-holding. Those who prefer to be heavily guided may struggle with this, but acclimating is vital.

This way of working permeates the GitLab culture, from a bias towards asynchronous communication, to maintaining a low level of shame, to being deliberate about scale.

Through continual iteration, the onboarding issue has become a comprehensive list. Those coming from colocated backgrounds may view this as overwhelming, or perhaps even unnecessary. GitLab

would rather you be inundated with useful information to absorb at your own pace than be uninformed. It comes naturally when a company values transparency.

Proactive approach to answering questions

The People Group maintains onboarding issues. This group attempts to proactively answer any question you may have before you have to ask it. If, after completing the onboarding issue, a new hire still has a question about process that wasn't answered, the natural next step is to work with a subject matter expert at GitLab to answer, then document.

Whenever a new hire brings up a valid process point that leads to a previously undocumented answer, the default mindset should be to answer and document right away. This requires a mindset of self-service, self-searching, and self-learning. It also requires diligence and empathy.

Documentation in action

GitLab's use of onboarding buddies is well documented. To provide context on how new team members can shape the future for colleagues to come by focusing on improvement, an example is showcased below.

1. An onboarding buddy asked a new hire what feedback she had after two weeks of onboarding.
1. She responded with feedback that the process felt siloed, and lacked the sense of community she had experienced prior. She referenced onboarding in a colocated space, where all new hires in a given week were forced to be in the same physical setting regardless of what department they would go on to serve in. This created a sense of belonging · that they were all in this thing together.
1. In discussing a remote solution to this, it was determined that a merge request should be put forth to encourage new hires (announced within the newteammembers Slack channel) to organize an optional group call with each other for those who prefer a more social new hire orientation experience. This may not be a comprehensive solution, but it is a minimal valuable change which can be bolstered in future iterations.
1. In turn, this merge request was produced and merged into Onboarding Buddy Responsibilities, creating a path for a more social onboarding experience for every successive wave of new team members.

Paying it forward

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The ideal response to learning a new answer at GitLab is to document said answer in an act of paying it forward, such that every new hire that comes after will be able to find this information more quickly. Plus, it removes the company-wide burden of having to develop this answer from scratch again. This mentality encompasses many operating principles.

1. Write things down
1. Be respectful of others' time
1. Responsibility over rigidity
1. Move fast by shipping the minimal valuable change

- 1. Ambitious
- 1. Ownership
- 1. Sense of urgency
- 1. Bias for action

Why is self-searching and self-learning uncomfortable at first?

For many companies, the frenetic pace of business creates a false sense of justification for bypassing documentation. Once this happens, the only way to consistently learn is to ask another person, over and over. At scale, this is an extraordinarily wasteful process that leads to exhaustion, watered-down instructions, and huge knowledge gaps as team members cycle in and out.

However, most employees are not empowered to shift an entire company culture to one that favors documentation. Thus, one typically builds a skillset of how and when to ask other humans in order to extract information vital to achieving their goals. They know it's a suboptimal approach, but may feel that they have no reasonable alternative. When you aren't given a handbook that is regularly updated and reliably actionable, it feels odd to seek answers first in documentation.

Humans tend to trust other humans more than words written in an online repository, which is why it's so vital to humanize a handbook by empowering all members of a company to contribute.

Public over private

A commonly-rooted habit that requires breaking at GitLab is this: oftentimes, people assume that by asking someone a question privately, they are doing everyone else a favor by bothering the fewest number of people.

At GitLab, we flip that notion on its head. We prefer public discourse over private, as this enables deeper collaboration. We encourage team members to consider making private issues public wherever possible so that we can all learn from the experience, rather than requiring a small group to spend effort translating those learnings in the future.

Answer with a link

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While making conversations public may feel inefficient in the moment, it is much more efficient long-term. It leads to significantly fewer interruptions. Team members should search for their own answers, and, if an answer is not readily found or the answer is not clear, ask in public as we all should have a low level of shame. Write down any new information discovered and pay it forward so that those coming after will have better efficiency built on top of practicing collaboration, inclusion, and documenting the results.

Minimizing interruptions creates a less chaotic workplace for all, and leads to something that is increasingly precious: long, uninterrupted periods of time where you can get into a state of flow.

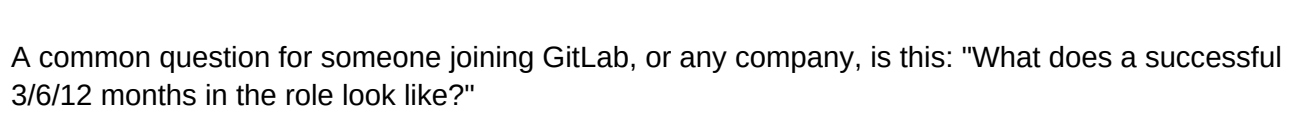
By answering with a link, you're doing the following:

1. Making your day more efficient, enabling you to disengage with work earlier and enjoy your surroundings, family, and community.
1. Allowing the recipient to ingest the answer on their own time.
1. Removing bias from the answer, which empowers the recipient to iterate further on what is documented by starting a merge request.
1. Leading by example, showing new team members that they too should strive to answer via documentation.

Say thanks

For people going out of their way to help you, also consider sharing public kudos in GitLab's thanks channel, showcasing the link to the entire channel and celebrating specific values that were lived in the process.

How self-learning leads to success in your role

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A common question for someone joining GitLab, or any company, is this: "What does a successful 3/6/12 months in the role look like?"

While the answer to this will vary depending on role level and department, it is possible to answer this more broadly. Regardless of where you operate within the organization, your ability to self-search, self-learn, and self-service will undoubtedly impact your success at GitLab.

GitLab's values are more than words on a wall. They are exercised daily and guide every decision.

Those who prefer significant amounts of guidance, are uncomfortable finding answers and proposing small changes without fear or ego, or struggle doing things themselves will need to acclimate quickly.

By embracing the autonomy that comes with a role at GitLab, you're able to ship more, and do so more quickly. Success is tied to one's ability to ship quickly, iterate deliberately, rely on themselves as a fact-finding resource, and to not lean on someone else to do something you're capable of accomplishing.

Success is also determined by your ambition to find and document answers that do not yet exist, collaborating with a spirit of blameless problem solving.

Said another way, success is less about specific outcomes and more about the way you approach work. It's impossible to know what will come your way on a day-to-day basis, but you can control the methodologies that drive your actions.

GitLab Knowledge Assessment: Adopting a Self-Service and Self-Learning Mentality

Complete all knowledge assessments in the Remote Work Foundation, to receive the Remote

Foundations Badge in GitLab Learn If you have questions, please reach out to our Learning & Development team at learning@gitlab.com.

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Contribute your lessons

Effective onboarding and positively influencing workflow habits is a challenge for all companies. If you or your organization has an experience that would benefit the greater world, consider creating a merge request and adding a contribution to this page.

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SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/stages.md

About the types of remote work models

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There are many types of remote arrangements, each with its unique benefits and challenges. GitLab is a fully remote company, and we work with organizations that fall into many different models - from fully co-located, to hybrid, to all-remote.

This guide is a strategic resource for any company looking to solidify your remote or hybrid workplace design. If your workplace is transitioning to remote or hybrid, use this alongside our guide to the phases of remote adaptation to create your transition plan.

If you'd like more comprehensive remote-work guidance, download [The Remote Playbook](#).

How to choose a remote team model

The ten models described here should actually be viewed on a spectrum or a sliding scale. You can borrow ideas from any of them to suit your team. Carefully weigh the benefits and disadvantages of each, and consider collecting feedback from your team before making a decision.

Once you've identified a model that should work for you, commit to the transition fully - but be open to iterating as feedback comes in.

For more, see [GitLab's guide to transitioning a company to remote work](#).

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In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, Darren (GitLab) and Anna-Karin (Because Mondays) discuss a number of challenges and solutions related to remote work, transitioning a company to remote, working asynchronously, and defaulting to documentation.

1. No remote

Some companies do not allow for any remote work. This could be due to a leadership mandate, or could be attributed to the nature of the business. For example, medical care, broadcasting from live events, and certain forms of manufacturing require team members to be onsite in a shared location.

It is worth noting, however, that even businesses which have historically been impossible to complete remotely are seeing new opportunity arise thanks to technological advancements.

The da Vinci Surgical System, for instance, has been used in telesurgery, and communications infrastructure is robust enough in some locales to support remote broadcasting.

Benefits and challenges of a non-remote team arrangement

In addition to the types of work that must be performed onsite, there are teams that can thrive in person and struggle in a distributed environment. Often, this is related to management style, but it's also common in local business where employees are members of the same community.

The major challenge of not allowing remote work is employee engagement and retention. Many people want more flexibility in their work, and co-located companies can struggle to allow team members enough freedom. If your people aren't able to integrate their work with their lives, they may choose to move to a workplace that offers better flexibility.

Multinational corporations with multiple offices across the globe are inherently distributed, even if they do not allow remote work. An employee in one office is inherently remote to another employee in another office, and a refusal to recognize this reality can create dysfunction when attempting to collaborate across offices.

2. Remote time

You can also think of "remote time" as "remote tolerated," meaning that it's allowed while not being the norm. This model allows all approved employees in a company to work some (but not all) days from home, or a place of their choosing.

This is commonly seen in agency and corporate environments where "remote Fridays" are sold as a perk to employment. In such scenarios, it is clear that leadership is not piloting remote work as a means to judge the feasibility of all-remote, but rather compromising with employee demands for greater flexibility.

Such employers are tolerant of some amount of working outside of the office, but still expect an individual to spend the bulk of their time in the office.

Some employers allow specific remote time, such as allowing an individual or team to work remotely a certain amount of days or hours per week. This can vary greatly amongst companies, with some being very rigid (e.g. the entire company may work remotely on Fridays, but there are no exceptions to the day) to very loose (e.g. a proven individual may work remotely up to three days per week of their choosing).

Benefits and challenges of allowing remote time

This model can be seen as a progression from the previous model, which increases flexibility to help improve the employee experience. The major benefit is an increase in satisfaction as your people are given more autonomy over their time.

Nonetheless, there is still significant ambiguity, and the looseness is generally left up to individual managers to decide. This also hampers mobility. Employees which must commute into the office a certain amount of days per week cannot reasonably explore relocation to areas which may be more amenable, and will likely not invest heavily in creating a focused, ergonomic workspace at home given the in-office requirement.

3. Remote exceptions

In this model, the great majority of a company works in the office (or multiple offices), while some employees may work remotely indefinitely due to their role or location. This is a common model, and is sometimes thought of as a hybrid-remote arrangement. However, it isn't truly hybrid, as the culture of this type of organization will still revolve around the office.

Benefits and challenges of remote exceptions

The major benefit of this model is that it allows office-based companies to hire outside their office locations - e.g. to provide 24-hour customer support, or to acquire top talent for a hard-to-source skill.

However, the challenges here are many. For office employees, this may be a "no remote" work arrangement, and they may wish for more flexibility. Meanwhile, remote team members are likely to feel disconnected and potentially overlooked. Because the remote experience is defined as an "exception," team members may be considered as an afterthought. This can result in high turnover.

Plus, exceptions who choose to relocate to an area far away from the company's headquarters are always at risk of being called back into the office. In such a scenario, they would be forced to either relocate back to a commutable distance from the headquarters, or resign and look for other employment.

4. Remote allowed

In this model, remote work is allowed for anyone at the company (with very few edge cases, such as those who are employed to physically service a building or must work with equipment that cannot be transported).

A variety of limitations can be applied on this model, depending on the organizational design. Some companies offer "hot desking" and/or require team members to come in a certain number of days per month. Others call employees into the office for events and meetings.

What distinguishes this model from hybrid-remote or remote-first is that the office is still considered to be the center of the company. Leadership often works in the office.

Benefits and challenges of allowing remote work

The biggest benefit to this model is flexibility for team members. Individuals can theoretically choose where and how they work, keeping access to the office for networking and collaboration while also having focus time away from its distractions.

However, job seekers should inquire to what degree remote workers are supported in such environments. There is a marked difference between allowing remote and supporting remote. Some employers believe that remote employees are bypassing a commute, therefore no additional support is warranted.

Other employers make concerted efforts to ensure that remote workers feel included, valued, and welcomed.

Firms such as Twitter and Shopify are embracing this approach following the COVID-19 pandemic.

5. Hybrid-remote

There are many flavors of hybrid-remote. The key attribute of a hybrid-remote arrangement is that some employees · but not all · are allowed to work remotely 100% of the time. These organizations have at least one physical office, and on any given day, a significant portion of the team physically commutes to that location.

Who works remotely, and who is in the office? This is where hybrid models vary the most. For some teams, certain people are in the office all or most of the time, and others are remote all or most of the time. Other companies are experimenting with assigned remote days and in-office days for everyone. At some workplaces, the employee can choose where they work and how. At many others, it's up to management.

Benefits and challenges of hybrid-remote work arrangements

Hybrid-remote is one of the most popular models currently being explored by organizations worldwide. The potential benefits are many: workplace flexibility; lower overhead from reduced attendance; increased productivity; and the potential for around-the-clock work.

However, hybrid-remote is a tempting compromise that masks many downsides. In a hybrid-remote organization, leaders are forced to manage two fundamentally distinct ways of working. There is administrative burden to manage a default-onsite experience and a default-offsite experience, and some employees may choose to oscillate between the two.

While such organizations work well for some employees, it's important to note that many hybrid-remote companies are not comfortable being publicly labeled as such. Their job vacancies may not be listed as remote-friendly. Should you apply for such a role, be prepared to lobby for assuming the role in a remote environment every step of the way.

<!-- TODO: Replace with screenshots. -->

> Sid Sijbrandij on Twitter/X

>

> Below is a thread about the future of remote work after the COVID-19 pandemic is over. I predict that remote will go through a trough of sorrow due to hybrid not working out, and most companies will return to being office based. But many all remote companies will see success.

Want to know more? Read GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij's WIRED article: [Hybrid Remote Work Offers the Worst of Both Worlds](#)

6. Remote days

In an effort to ensure that there is only ever one playing field to manage, some companies may allow remote days where the entire company (executives included) works remotely at the same time. This is a less commonly seen model which may be most attractive to organizations that have invested heavily in real estate, yet where most or all jobs can be done remotely and where most people experience a long, disruptive commute.

Benefits and challenges of remote days

This approach may lead to stronger remote muscle being built, and remote-first workflows used on remote days could become the default even on colocated days. The entire team is subject to a forcing function: on some workdays, office equipment and workflows just aren't an option.

Remote days can be very beneficial to teams seeking a reduction in commute time, but who also want to keep equitable "face time" and in-person interaction without excluding any members of the team. Meetings can be scheduled on office days, while remote days can effectively become focus days. This also provides some flexibility for team members to reduce work/life conflict.

However, this can be challenging because of the significant context switch that happens between one work environment and the other. Teams need to be prepared with strong workflows so they're able to be effective in a constantly shifting workplace. This model may also reduce flexibility for ad-hoc needs such as appointments, since office time can easily start to be thought of as obligatory.

7. Remote first

Remote-first organizations optimize their workplaces for remote. They create documentation, policies, and workflows that work when assuming that 100% of the organization is remote, even if some continue to occasionally visit a company-owned office.

These companies work to ensure that offices are simply venues to work remotely from, and are not the epicenter of power or culture.

Quora shifting to remote-first in June 2020 is an example of this, as is Upwork's move in May 2020.

Benefits and challenges of working remote-first

Remote-first is a model with many benefits, and few challenges. The benefits are the flexibility, productivity and employee satisfaction that come with remote work. Because workflows are designed to function wherever team members are located, this model offers as much flexibility as all-remote. In addition, team members have access to an office where they can connect with colleagues and have in-person meetings as desired.

The biggest challenge with a remote-first team is engagement: different team members will engage differently with remote and on-site work options, and it's possible for some people to

"fall through the cracks." These organizations should use data to monitor engagement and satisfaction, and implement programs to make sure employees stay connected to the company.

8. Remote only

A remote-only organization has no physical office, and all work is done remotely. This is very similar to being all-remote, with one major distinction: most people are located in the same geographic region, so work hours are biased towards one time zone.

Many companies allow employees to work remotely, but maintain "core team hours." InVision, for example, has members spread across multiple countries and time zones, but aims to achieve "at least a 4-hour overlap with InVision's core team hours, 10am-6pm Eastern Standard Time."

This tends to attract employees who are in relative close proximity to one another, or at the very least, in a nearby time zone even if located in a different hemisphere.

Benefits and challenges of timezone-biased remote work

For smaller remote organizations, this is a very common model. It offers all the benefits of remote work: lower overhead without real estate to maintain; greater flexibility for team members; and higher engagement and retention.

There are two main challenges: first, teams that mostly share a timezone can default to synchronous work, including a heavy meeting load, because they lack a forcing function encouraging them to develop better async practices.

Second, a timezone-biased company that wants to scale its team can run into sourcing challenges if the best people for the job are outside its preferred timezones. Ultimately, organizations using this model may shift to all-remote.

9. All-remote

"All-remote" describes organizations that do not maintain offices and work globally across many time zones. GitLab is an all-remote company, with team members in 65+ countries.

In all-remote companies, there is no effort placed on trying to coordinate team members to a given time zone. Rather, a bias towards asynchronous communication encourages documentation, discourages synchronous meetings as a default for collaboration, and provides greater flexibility for each member to determine the working hours that best suites their lifestyle.

This goes beyond enabling a work from home arrangement; all-remote creates a work from anywhere arrangement.

{{< youtube "jdN5mj5ieLk?start=2115" >}}

As part of a Harvard Business School case study interview (shown above), GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij spoke with Professor Prithwiraj Choudhury on the various stages of remote work.

> We think it's time for clear differentiation between companies which allow remote, and companies that will not allow you to come into an office.

>

> People will start understanding the difference. If there is no headquarters, you're not at a satellite office. · GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij

Benefits and challenges of all-remote work arrangements

GitLab believes that the benefits of remote work outshine its challenges. Benefits include the ability to hire top-tier talent anywhere in the world; happier and more engaged team members; and societal impacts such as distribution of opportunity, increased diversity, and reduced traffic. There's plenty more: read our guide to the benefits of remote work.

However, this does come with disadvantages. These may include loneliness, challenges with onboarding, difficulty building and maintaining culture, and breakdown of boundaries between work and life. Read our complete guide to the drawbacks of remote work for more detail.

10. Strictly remote

Taken to its extreme, a strictly remote company would never meet in person and never permit synchronous meetings. This seems impractical, and we are not yet aware of a company that adheres to this. If you are aware of any such company, please create a merge request and assign to @dmurph to evaluate.

GitLab Remote Foundations Badge

To test your knowledge about remote work, consider taking the GitLab Remote Foundations course in our learning experience platform to earn the Remote Foundations badge. This badge can be earned by anyone who wants to learn about GitLab's approach to remote work.

{{% include "includes/isthisadviceanygoodremote.md" %}}

Contribute your lessons

GitLab believes that all-remote is the future of work, and remote companies have a shared responsibility to show the way for other organizations who are embracing it. If you or your company has an experience that would benefit the greater world, consider creating a merge request and adding a contribution to this page.

Return to the main all-remote page.

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/stories.md

{{< all-remote/stories >}}

{{% include "includes/take-gitlab-for-a-spin.md" %}}

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/terminology.md

{style="max-width: 50%;"}</p>
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<div data-bbox="114 155 919 221" data-label="Text">
<p>GitLab is the world's largest all-remote company. We are 100% remote, with no company-owned offices anywhere on the planet. We have {{< team-size >}} team members in more than 65 countries. On this page, we're detailing why we refer to this structure as all-remote, and why we prefer this term over others.</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="119 238 377 254" data-label="Text">
<p>What does "all-remote" mean?</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="114 270 903 320" data-label="Text">
<p>All-remote means that each individual in an organization is empowered to work and live where they are most fulfilled. By including the word "all" in "all-remote," it makes clear that every team member is equal. No one, not even the executive team, meets in-person on a daily basis.</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="114 337 460 354" data-label="Text">
<p>{{< youtube "IU2nTj6NSIQ?start=181" >}}</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="114 370 925 419" data-label="Text">
<p>In the video above, GitLab Head of Remote Darren M. discusses the topic of all-remote during an interview with Stuart Miniman, host of theCUBE and GM of Content at SiliconANGLE Media. A portion is transcribed below.</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="114 436 926 868" data-label="List-Group">
<ul style="list-style-type: none; padding-left: 0;">
> We don't say you have to work from home · you can work from anywhere.
>
> That's wherever you're most comfortable. Maybe that's a co-working space, maybe that's at a friend's house, maybe that's a different place every month.
>
> We have people [at GitLab] who travel all around the world, and every month they're in a different time zone. We have over 1,100 employees, but none of them operate their days quite the same as anyone else.
>
> The beautiful thing about all-remote is it truly makes everyone a first-class team member. A lot of people will say in a hybrid-remote setting, 'If I don't go to the office frequently enough, I miss out on some things, or maybe I miss out on praise or promotion opportunities.' You feel inferior or deprioritized, as if you don't fully belong.
>
> In an environment like that, you have to take certain approaches to include people. You have to be intentional to include those remote individuals, whereas if it's all-remote, you're all on a level playing field.
>
> All-remote enables a workforce that may have been rejected at other stages · caregivers, working parents, or military spouses, where their spouse has to move at each new deployment. A lot of these people might say 'It's too complicated to continue to reinvent my career with every move along the way.'

All-remote is different than remote-first. A remote-first organization embodies many of the principles that create a thriving all-remote culture · handbook-first documentation, asynchronous workflows, no hybrid calls, etc. · but these entities reserve the right to establish a physical company headquarters.

It is possible to find remote-first companies with a healthy, understanding culture that works to support both colocated and remote colleagues. Prospective employees should do their own due diligence to make sure the requisite values are established and lived out.

No company-owned offices

The company does not have an office occupied by their employees in an all-remote setting. By extension, this ensures that every member of leadership is remote, creating a level playing field that is not possible when even one or two executives congregate daily in the same physical space.

A more inclusive work environment

Such a structure ensures that each team member is given autonomy to create the workspace that works best for them, in a place that suits them, creating an environment that is naturally more inclusive.

No location hierarchy

In an all-remote company, there is no single location or region that is more important than another. Team members work asynchronously, ensuring that no time zone is seen as more significant than another.

Freedom to change locations

All-remote is not partial to where you work, nor how frequently you relocate. All-remote does not mandate that you work from home; it simply affirms that there is no company office to commute to. This empowers team members to work from co-working spaces, dedicated rental offices, their home, planes/trains, hotels, parks, or anywhere else where there is a strong, reliable internet connection.

Because there is no central office, all-remote enables team members to live and work in underserved and rural locales. This bolsters economies in small communities and simultaneously reduces infrastructure strain on dense cities.

What "all-remote" does not mean

Let's address some of the common misconceptions about all-remote work.

First things first: An all-remote company means there is no office where multiple people are based. The only way to not have people in a satellite office is not to have a main office. It's not that we don't have a headquarters, it is that we have 1,000+ (and growing) headquarters!

The terms "remote" and "distributed" are often used interchangeably, but they're not quite the same. We prefer the term "remote" because "distributed" suggests multiple physical offices.

"Remote" is also the most common term to refer to the absence of a physical workspace, and being able to do your job from anywhere.

For employees, being part of an all-remote company does not mean working independently or being isolated, because it's not a substitute for human interaction.

Technology allows us to stay closely in touch with our teams, whether asynchronously in text or in real time with high-fidelity conversations through video. Teams should collaborate closely, communicate often, build relationships virtually, and feel like valuable members of a larger team.

Working remotely also doesn't mean you're physically constrained to home. You're free to work wherever you want. That could be at home with family, a coffee shop, a co-working space, or your local library while your little one is enjoying story-time. You can have frequent video chats or virtual pairing sessions with coworkers throughout the day, and you can even meet up with other coworkers to work together in person if you're located near each other.

At the organizational level, "all-remote" does not mean simply offshoring work. Instead, it means you're able to hire the best talent from all around the world. It's also not a management paradigm. You still have a hierarchical organization, but with a focus on output instead of input.

All in all, remote is fundamentally about freedom and individual choice. At GitLab, we value your results, regardless of where you get your work done.

Careers, not outsourcing or offshoring

It's important to recognize that all-remote is not a synonym for outsourcing or offshoring. Outsourcing typically has a central authority who farms work out to low-cost regions for the primary purpose of saving money. This is not the same as spreading career-building opportunity to underserved regions. All-remote seeks to hire the world's best talent, regardless of location.

In-person considerations

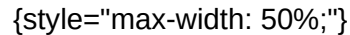
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GitLab believes that in-person interactions are valuable. We are intentional about gathering the entire team every 9 to 12 months for a shared experience (GitLab Contribute), and we encourage team members to gather in-person for reimbursed holiday gatherings, GitLab Commit events, and other opportunities such as conferences and trade shows.

GitLab also gathers its e-group for a quarterly four-day offsite. These offsites are planned and highly structured as to create exceptional efficiencies. The agenda, takeaways, and changes are all documented for the rest of the company to see, with broader company discussion in a dedicated e-group Slack channel. This is intentionally designed to be transparent.

There is a marked difference between being intentional and selective about in-person interactions, and forcing a team to endure a daily commute.

Why does the term "all-remote" matter?

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We feel that terminology is important when detailing the future of work. Brushing this off as merely semantics allows each person to interpret terms differently. This could lead to problematic conflation. A shared understanding of what all-remote is, and how it differs from other terms related to remote work, is vital to productive conversation.

Alternative terms that miss the mark

Remote is fundamentally about freedom and individual choice. At GitLab, we value your results, regardless of where you get your work done.

{{< youtube "jdN5mj5ieLk?start=2115" >}}

As part of a Harvard Business School case study interview (shown above), GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij spoke with Professor Prithwiraj Choudhury on the various stages of remote work.

> We think this model will be called all-remote.

>

> We think it's time for clear differentiation between companies which allow remote, and companies that will not allow you to come into an office.

>

> People will start understanding the difference. If there is no headquarters, you're not at a satellite office. You're not a second-class team member. · GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij

Distributed

All all-remote teams are distributed by nature, but not all distributed teams are inherently all-remote.

In an all-remote environment, there is no central authority dictating where teams must be built. The term "distributed" does not absolutely imply remote. Many companies refer to themselves as distributed, noting that they have several colocated teams strategically placed in various locales around the globe. While these offices are remote to each other, individuals hired into said offices are still forced to commute.

There are distributed environments where certain individuals are fully remote, and are never required to commute to a company-owned office. This is not the same as all-remote, as there exists a location hierarchy where remote team members are disadvantaged by missing out on colocated conversation. A more appropriate term for this type of environment is hybrid-remote.

Fully-distributed

Even the term "fully distributed" falls short, as it does not ensure that there are no company-owned offices in the mix. Taken a step further, a company with no offices that bills itself as fully-distributed could plant an office in the future and still maintain its fully-distributed branding. In doing so, it would create an unequal playing field for team members.

Conversely, an all-remote company is bound to never plant an office, removing that worry from the minds of team members.

Remote-only

While the term "remote-only" does preclude a company-owned office from entering the equation, it is unnecessarily limiting. The word "only" is particularly problematic. This implies that under no circumstance can team members be in the same physical space, while all-remote provides more options on this front. As mentioned earlier, GitLab values in-person interactions and plans them intentionally. All-remote affords this flexibility.

Evaluating a remote company

If you encounter a company that uses any of the above terms interchangeably, consider reading our guide on evaluating remote jobs. In it, you'll find a number of probing questions that will uncover the true identity of the work environment.

For added context, consider reading GitLab's guide on the various stages of remote work, as well as a comprehensive look at hybrid-remote.

```
{{% include "includes/isthisadviceanygoodremote.md" %}}
```

Contribute your lessons

GitLab believes that all-remote is the future of work, and remote companies have a shared responsibility to show the way for other organizations who are embracing it. If you or your company has an experience that would benefit the greater world, consider creating a merge request and adding a contribution to this page.

[Return to the main all-remote page.](#)

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/the-gitlab-test-remote-work.md

{style="max-width: 50%;"}</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="114 718 876 785" data-label="Text">
<p>GitLab is one of the world's largest all-remote organizations. As we've scaled remote, we've documented over 40 individual guides that comprehensively cover the proven principles of remote-first work, culture, process, and optimization. The foundational elements are distilled in The Remote Playbook.</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="114 800 847 835" data-label="Text">
<p>For some, there's still a looming question: How do I know if we're running a great remote operation?</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox="120 850 488 868" data-label="Text">
<p>The GitLab Test: 12 Steps to Better Remote</p>
</div>

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Enter The GitLab Test: 12 Steps to Better Remote. Kudos to The Joel Test for the nomenclature inspiration.

The great part about this test is it takes around 10 minutes (or less, if you read quickly). Each question is a quick yes or no. A score of 12 is perfect and 11 is tolerable. 10 or lower indicates that there are significant office-first strongholds which are preventing your organization from reaching the goal of Phase 4 of Remote Adaption: Intentionality.

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1. Are senior leaders remote by default?

The quickest way to send the clearest signal that remote is the future is to start at the top of the organizational chart. Remove execs from the physical office, and you'll quickly figure out what gaps you need to fill with tools and process.

If you force the executive team to work remotely for a meaningful amount of time (over one month, in most cases), you'll discover communication gaps, as well as voids in tooling and process.

If senior leaders default to gathering in the same physical office, decisions are apt to be made less transparently and office-first norms will thwart progress in shifting consensus gathering, brainstorming, collaboration, and decision making to remote-first.

2. Are team members empowered to define their working hours?

Excellent remote teams are able to move work forward in relative concert without stiffly defined working hours. Broadly speaking, defined working hours create comfort in collaborating synchronously, even when it's more efficient to work asynchronously. The bigger issue is the implied reliance on synchronicity. This creates a foundational risk that collaboration, coordination, and iterative decision making grinds to a halt when someone cannot work their defined shift.

In areas where defined working hours are required by the role or client, great remote organizations will add redundancy or bolstered documentation to enable team members to enjoy the spoils of a non-linear workday to whatever degree possible.

3. Is most communication about work done asynchronously?

There are valid reasons to work synchronously. Communicating about work is best done asynchronously. This includes status updates, FYIs, process documentation (e.g. how to alert your security team about a suspected phishing attempt). It also includes meeting about a meeting.

Prerequisites for this to work well are below.

1. Leveraging a single tool to funnel communication about work (e.g. GitLab, Friday, Dropbox

Spaces, Qatalog)

1. Documented communication guidelines on how and where to communicate about work

1. Executive commitment to transparency

4. Are your values, and how to live them, explicitly defined and documented?

Great remote organizations undergo an audit which seeks to convert tacit knowledge (e.g. implied knowledge) to explicit knowledge (e.g. documented knowledge). This begins with a values audit.

It's not enough to have core values documented on a company website. Each core value needs operating principles, such that a globally distributed team can reference tangible examples of how common terms like collaboration, iteration, and results are lived out. This also creates shared understanding of what values mean to your specific organization. Ideally, all team members are empowered to contribute proposals to bolster values and share newly-discovered methods of living them out.

5. Does every functional department surface work in a single tool with company-wide visibility?

Different company functions may require different tools to drive results. For example, a Design team may use MURAL, Figma, and Photoshop, while a Marketing Operations team leverages tools like Salesforce and Marketo. Great remote organizations leverage a single tool (e.g. GitLab, Friday, Dropbox Spaces, Qatalog) to surface work that is happening in department-specific tools. By surfacing ongoing work, via links or other documentation, this central tool acts as organizational glue. It enables a distributed team to discover what other teams are working toward with clicks instead of meetings. This intentional transparency fosters alignment, purpose, and enables feedback to occur earlier.

6. Does your organization work handbook-first?

Great remote organizations are careful not to use the word "documentation" when they really mean "handbook-first." Documentation without taxonomy is a recipe for textual chaos, which is no better than verbal chaos caused by a perpetual loop of unstructured synchronous meetings. Handbook-first is an intentional approach to seek answers first before interrupting someone's flow, and to document changes first in the appropriate place before making announcements in a chat tool or email.

7. Is informal communication formalized?

Great remote organizations do not leave camarad